Name: Kaarthic Pranav
Matriculation No: 55795950

Name: Abhijith
Matriculation No:

LoopTop: Refurbished Laptop Subscription for University Students

1. Summary

The proposed business aims to offer good-quality refurbished laptops to university students through a simple monthly subscription. Instead of paying several hundred euros upfront for a new laptop, a student pays a small monthly fee and receives a professionally refurbished business laptop, with repairs and a replacement device included.

Many students start their degree with an old, slow or broken laptop, and a new one is a large expense at the exact moment they are also paying rent, deposits and semester fees. At the same time, companies replace thousands of perfectly usable business laptops every few years. LoopTop connects these two situations: it buys ex-corporate laptops in bulk, refurbishes them, and rents them to students for as long as they need them.

The business will target bachelor and master students in Germany, starting with one university city, as well as international students who arrive without a laptop and do not want to buy one for a limited stay. Its competitive advantage will be a low monthly price, fast repair or swap service, no long-term contract, and a clear sustainability message.

For example, a student could subscribe to a refurbished 14-inch business laptop with 16 GB of RAM and an SSD for about €19 per month. If the laptop breaks during the semester, LoopTop repairs it or sends a replacement within a few working days. When the student graduates, they return the device, which is checked, cleaned and sent to the next student.

The long-term vision is to build a trusted student technology brand that makes reliable laptops affordable for everyone in higher education, while keeping devices in use for longer and reducing electronic waste.

2. Business Problem and Opportunity

The problem

- A new laptop suitable for studying typically costs several hundred euros, which is difficult for many students to pay at once.
- Students often depend on one device for lectures, assignments and exams, so a breakdown can seriously disrupt their studies.
- Repairs are slow and expensive, and students rarely have a backup device.

- International and exchange students may only need a laptop for one or two years and do not want to buy one.
- Companies replace large numbers of working business laptops, many of which are not reused locally.

The proposed solution
Offer refurbished business laptops to students through a flexible monthly subscription with repair and replacement included. The business will focus on:

- Durable ex-corporate laptop models that are easy to repair and have good spare-part availability.
- Professional data wiping, testing, battery checks and cleaning before every new subscription.
- A simple online sign-up with student verification and delivery or campus pick-up.
- A repair-or-swap promise during the subscription, so students are never left without a working device for long.
- Monthly cancellation after a short minimum period, with collection and reuse of returned devices.

Core value proposition: Give students a reliable laptop for a small monthly fee, with repairs included and no large upfront payment, while giving business laptops a second life.

3. Align Deliverables with Strategic Business Objectives

The project deliverables must directly support the business's goals of making laptops affordable for students, offering dependable service, and building a sustainable and profitable subscription business.

Strategic Objective	**Key Deliverable**	**Success measure**
Make laptops affordable for students	Subscription plans priced for student budgets	Monthly price below comparable financing or rental offers
Provide reliable devices	Standard refurbishment and testing process	Low failure rate in the first 90 days
Keep students working	Repair-or-swap service process	Replacement delivered within 3 working days
Build student trust	Clear terms, reviews and customer support	High satisfaction scores and low cancellation rate

Strategic Objective	Key Deliverable	Success measure
Enter the student market	Pilot launch at one university city	250 active subscribers in the first year
Achieve profitability	Financial and pricing model	Positive operating profit in year one
Reduce electronic waste	Device reuse and responsible recycling process	Each laptop used by several students before recycling

The initial service would first be tested at one university with a limited range of two or three laptop models. On the basis of its success, the business should expand to more cities and models only after the pilot meets its service, quality and financial targets.

4. Enroll Sponsors

The financial resources, practical expertise and strategic direction needed to develop the business will be provided by the project sponsors.

Sponsor	Contribution	Estimated Benefit
Founders	Initial investment and management	Business growth and ownership
IT asset disposal company	Supply of used business laptops	Steady sales channel for used devices
Refurbishment partner	Repairs, spare parts and technical support	Repair and service revenue
University student services	Campus promotion and pick-up points	Better support for students
Logistics partner	Delivery and returns	Shipping revenue
Investor	Working capital for fleet growth	Potential financial return

Sponsorship strategy: Initially approach IT asset disposal companies and refurbishment workshops to secure a reliable supply of devices and spare parts. Then contact student unions and university start-up centres for promotion and campus pick-up points before committing to a large laptop fleet.

An important distinction is that laptop manufacturers are the source of the devices, not sponsors or partners. Their brand names and logos should not be used in a way that suggests official endorsement. The universities are also not customers; they only help the business reach students.

5. Quantify Financial and Organizational Benefits

Financial benefits

- Students avoid a large upfront payment and can budget a small, predictable monthly cost.
- Students save on repair costs because repairs and replacements are included in the subscription.
- The business earns recurring monthly revenue, which makes income more predictable than one-off sales.
- Each laptop can generate revenue from several students over its useful life.
- Additional income can come from setup fees, accessories and the resale of devices at the end of their life.

Organizational benefits

- Develop specialist knowledge in laptop refurbishment, testing and secure data wiping.
- Build long-term relationships with device suppliers, repair partners and universities.
- Create a recognisable student brand with a clear sustainability message.
- Create part-time jobs for technicians and student ambassadors.
- Develop a circular business model that keeps devices in use for longer.

6. Identify Project Team Member Requirements and Critical Knowledge Sources

The project needs a small team with technical, commercial and financial skills.

Team member	Responsibilities	Critical knowledge required
Project manager/founder	Planning, budgeting and coordination	Business strategy and project management
Refurbishment technician	Testing, repairing and preparing laptops	Hardware diagnostics, repairs and secure data wiping
IT support specialist	Software setup and student help desk	Operating systems, common study software and troubleshooting
Procurement specialist	Buying devices and spare parts	Used-IT market, grading standards and price negotiation
Marketing and partnerships manager	Student marketing and university contacts	Student market, social media and partnership building

Team member	Responsibilities	Critical knowledge required
Customer service and logistics coordinator	Orders, deliveries, returns and swaps	Shipping processes and customer communication
Legal and data protection adviser	Contracts and privacy compliance	Rental contract law and GDPR
Accountant or financial adviser	Cash flow, costing and financial analysis	Subscription accounting, depreciation and ROI

Critical knowledge sources

The project team should obtain information from:

- IT asset disposal companies and certified refurbishers.
- Laptop service manuals and spare-part suppliers.
- Students, student unions and international offices through surveys and interviews.
- Existing device-rental and refurbished-electronics companies, as competitor references.
- Rental contract rules, consumer protection rules and GDPR guidance.
- Electronic-waste and recycling regulations for returned devices.
- Pilot results, including failure rates, repair times and customer feedback.

7. Determine Key Risk Factors and Failure Indicators

- **Device reliability risk:** Refurbished laptops may fail more often than expected. Track failure rates by model and stop buying models that perform poorly.
- **Non-return and damage risk:** Some students may damage devices or not return them. Use student verification, a small deposit and clear damage rules.
- **Supply risk:** Good-quality used laptops may become harder to buy at the planned price. Work with more than one supplier and keep a buffer stock.
- **Demand risk:** Demand may be seasonal and concentrated at the start of each semester. Plan stock and marketing around semester dates.
- **Data protection risk:** Personal data could remain on returned devices. Use certified data-wiping software for every returned laptop.

Failure indicators include a high early-failure rate, many late or missing returns, slow replacement times, a high cancellation rate after the first semester, and a subscriber count well below the pilot target.

8. Develop Project Assumptions

The business case is based on the following assumptions, which must be tested before major investment.

- **Market demand:** A meaningful number of students prefer a low monthly payment to buying a laptop upfront.
- **Device availability:** Used business laptops can be bought in sufficient quantity at around €220 per device.
- **Device life:** A refurbished laptop can be used for at least three years across several subscriptions.
- **Repair costs:** Repairs and spare parts can be kept within the planned monthly cost per subscriber.
- **Willingness to pay:** Students will pay about €19 per month for a reliable laptop with repairs included.
- **Return behaviour:** Most students will return their laptops on time and in reasonable condition.
- **University support:** Student services or student unions will allow promotion on campus.
- **Competitive pricing:** The monthly price can cover devices, repairs, logistics and operating costs.
- **Legal compliance:** The rental terms and data handling can meet German consumer protection and GDPR requirements.
- **Environmental responsibility:** Devices that can no longer be used can be recycled through certified channels.

These assumptions should be reviewed at each project milestone. The business should not assume that universities or laptop manufacturers will officially endorse or purchase the service.

9. Estimate Capital and Operational Costs

The following is an illustrative first-year budget in euros for a small business operating in Germany. These figures are planning estimates, not supplier quotations, and exclude VAT where applicable.

Estimated initial investment

Capital or startup expense	Estimated cost
Initial fleet of 150 refurbished laptops at €220 each	€33,000

Capital or startup expense	Estimated cost
Testing, data-wiping and repair equipment	€3,000
Spare parts stock (batteries, keyboards, chargers, SSDs)	€4,000
Website, subscription platform and branding	€5,000
Initial legal, insurance and business setup	€3,500
Launch marketing at the pilot university	€2,500
Total estimated startup investment	**€51,000**

Estimated first-year operating costs

Operating expense	Annual estimate
Part-time refurbishment technician	€14,400
Storage and workshop space	€4,800
Delivery, returns and swap logistics	€3,600
Marketing and student ambassadors	€3,000
Software, payment fees, administration and accounting	€3,000
Insurance and damage reserve	€4,200
Total operating costs	**€33,000**

The staffing assumption is deliberately lean. The founders will handle management, marketing and customer service themselves during the first year and may defer a full salary. It should not be interpreted as a full-time payroll.

10. Determine Return on Investment (ROI)

ROI measures the financial return relative to the initial investment.

ROI = Net Profit / Initial Investment * 100

For this business, the financial model should separate the startup investment from the ongoing operating expenses and the cost of using and repairing the laptop fleet.

Illustrative first-year financial scenario

Assume the business has an average of 250 active subscribers during its first year.

Financial assumption	Amount
Monthly subscription fee per student	€19
Average active subscribers	250
Subscription revenue (€19 × 12 months × 250)	€57,000
Setup and delivery fees (300 sign-ups × €25)	€7,500
Total revenue	€64,500
Device depreciation and repair parts (€6 per subscriber per month)	€18,000
Gross profit	€46,500
Annual operating costs	€33,000
Operating profit before tax	€13,500
Initial startup investment	€51,000

These figures assume that the €6 monthly cost per subscriber covers the wear of each laptop over a three-year life plus typical spare parts. Additional laptops bought during the year to grow the fleet are financed from subscription income and treated through depreciation. Damage, non-returns and logistics must be allocated correctly in the final model to avoid double-counting or underestimating costs.

ROI calculation

Using operating profit as a simplified first-year proxy for return:

ROI = €13,500 / €51,000 * 100

Illustrative ROI = 26.5%

This is a preliminary operating-return estimate, not a guaranteed investment return. It excludes taxes, financing costs, additional working capital for fleet growth, and any startup expenses not already included in the budget. Because revenue is recurring, the return should improve in the second year as the subscriber base grows and the initial fleet is already paid for.

11. Document the Business Case

Phase	Duration	Description
Phase 1 Market Research	1-2 Months	Survey and interview students, talk to student services, analyse competing rental and financing offers, and test willingness to pay.
Phase 2 Supplier Selection	2-3 Months	Select device suppliers and a refurbishment partner, test sample laptops, and agree prices, grading standards and spare-part supply.
Phase 3 Platform and Process Setup	3-4 Months	Build the subscription website, write the rental terms, set up data-wiping and testing procedures, and prepare the first fleet.
Phase 4 Pilot Launch	5-8 Months	Launch at one university at the start of the semester, monitor failures, repair times and returns, and collect student feedback.
Phase 5 Commercial Expansion	9-12 Months	Expand to more universities and laptop models only after the pilot shows reliable service, real demand and acceptable profitability.

Expected business outcomes

At the end of the first year, the project aims to have:

- Established a reliable refurbished-laptop subscription service at one university.
- Developed supplier relationships and a repeatable refurbishment and quality-control process.
- Built a base of around 250 active student subscribers with good satisfaction scores.
- Demonstrated that students are willing to pay a monthly fee for a laptop with repairs included.
- Established a viable financial model with a pathway toward recovering the initial investment.
- Created a foundation for expanding to other universities and cities.

Overall recommendation

This business has good potential if the laptops are reliable, the repair service is fast, and most students return their devices on time. We will first run a small pilot at one university to test demand, failure rates and pricing before investing heavily in a larger fleet. If the results are positive, we will expand to more universities and more laptop models.

Before finalising the budget, we need to decide whether to refurbish the laptops ourselves or buy them already refurbished from a partner and focus only on the subscription service and customer experience.